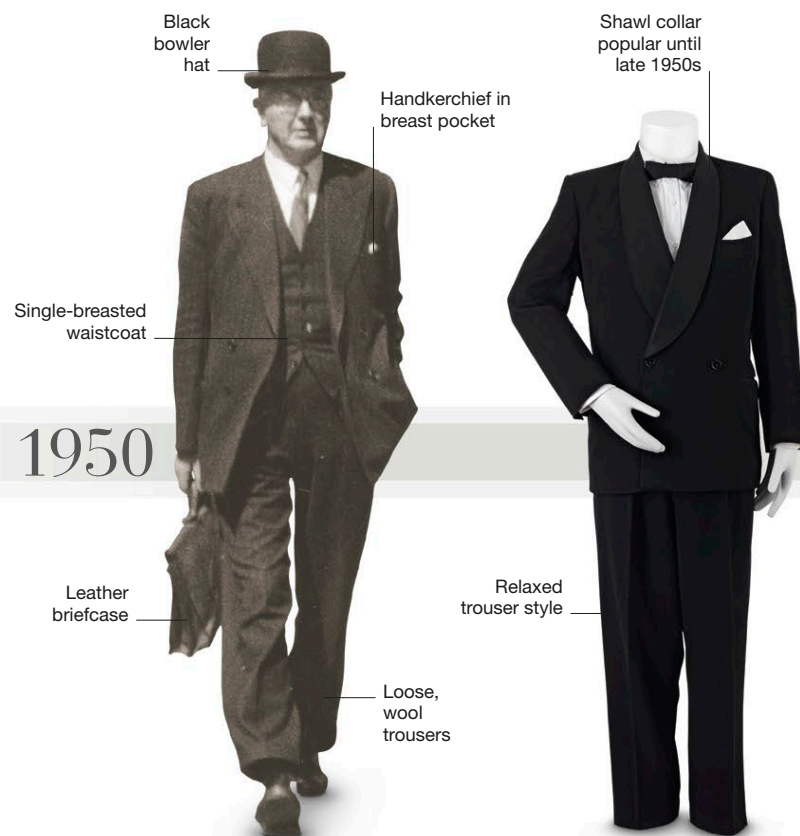


1950–1955

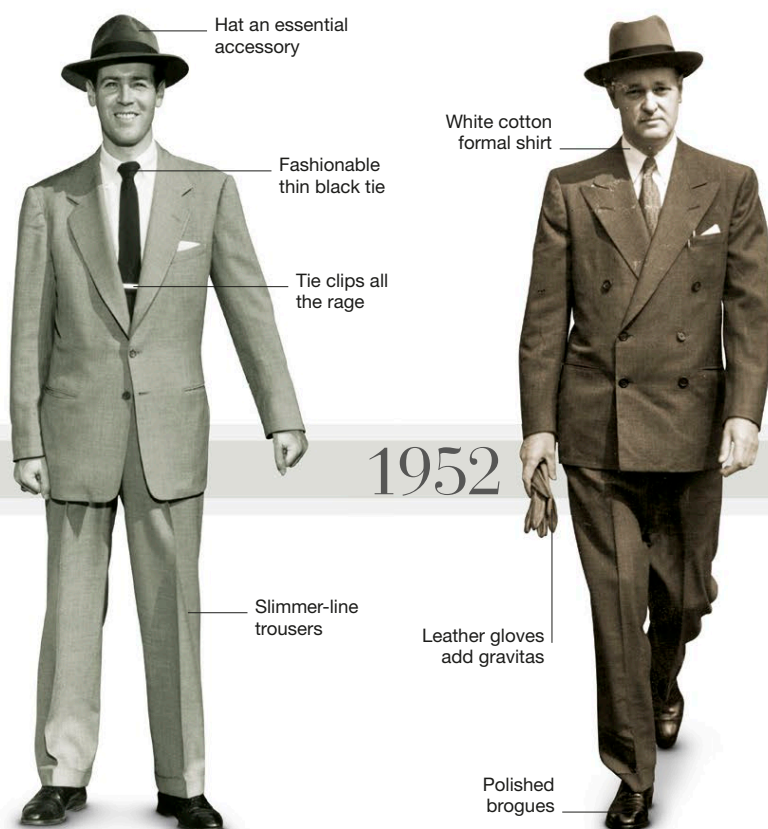
CASUAL AND POLISHED

After years in military uniform, men were back in civilian clothes, and now wanted to indulge themselves a little and dress in a more relaxed style. Clothing makers adapted to the new mood. From the late 1940s generously cut, double-breasted jackets were teamed with wide-leg trousers, often pleated and with a centre crease and turn-ups. In Britain tailors in London's prestigious Savile Row launched a Neo-Edwardian look that harked back to a time of luxury. Shoulders followed a more natural line, rather than being padded, and jackets in expensive fabrics were cut for a slimmer fit. Italian menswear makers pioneered lightweight suiting using fine fabrics such as silk – the perfect balance between casual and polished. The shorter, sportier-looking continental jacket was very popular in the late 1950s. All shades of grey were fashionable, especially in flannel pinstripe.



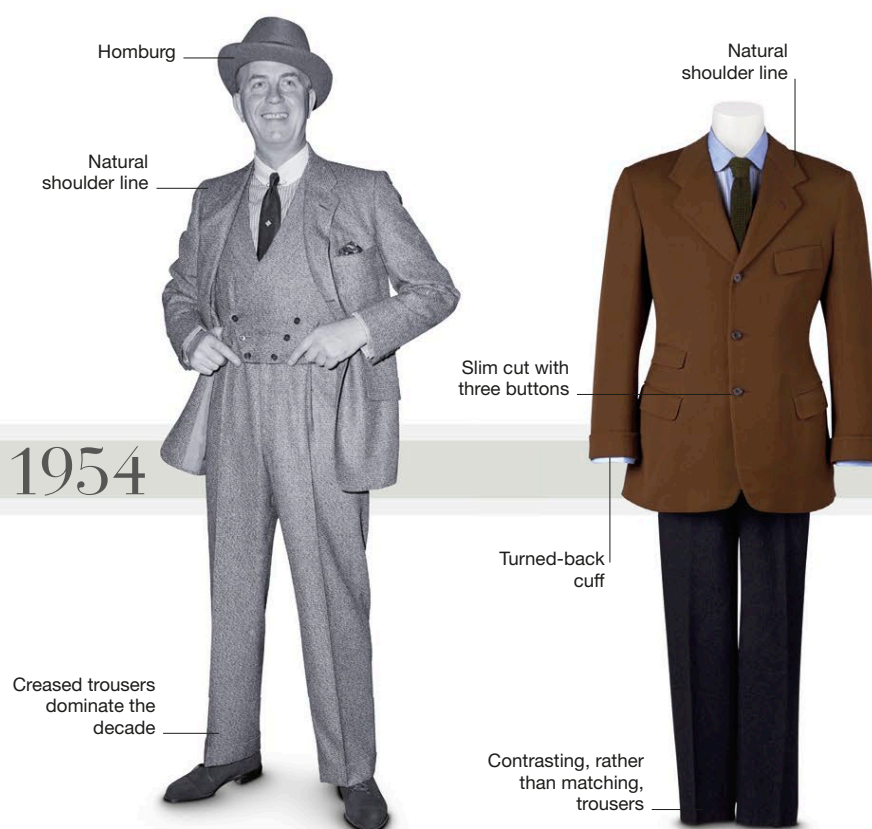
Business suit In the City of London, menswear retained formal dress codes. This gentleman wears a tailored, dark wool three-piece suit and bowler hat – a look little changed from the 1850s.

Dressing up The tuxedo, or dinner suit, first worn in the late 1800s, was very much in vogue during the 1950s, when men's clothing included formal wear for most evening occasions.



Work style In Europe and West Coast America suits became less formal, even for the businessman. A softer, slimmer jacket was preferred, along with a slightly tapered trouser leg.

Executive US ambassador to Moscow George Frost Kennan, wears a finely pinstriped, double-breasted grey flannel suit – typical attire for the prudent, mature “company man”.



Old and new A debut design from Christian Dior's menswear line, launched in 1954, this suit harks back to the Edwardian era, but details such as the cropped waistcoat give it a fresh spin.

Neo-Edwardian This jacket and trouser ensemble typifies the New Edwardian tailoring of the 1950s. The brown wool jacket is cut on a long line, with a slightly waisted effect.